

SPY at 7,437: The 1998 Question

A compositional and cyclical read of the S&P 500 — every stream in the analyzer, the dot-com cycle overlaid tick-for-tick, the valuation math on what SPY actually owns, and the probability distribution for what comes next.

As of Jul 30, 2026 · rev. Jul 31 (Big_Nuts cross-asset pack) SPX 7,437.63 · SPY \$741.69

Streams: FRED · Telegram KOL · Substack/newsletters · Gov-insider · Social · Prices

I VERDICT

The analog phase-band is late-1998 to early-2000 — and the cross-asset tape says lean late.

Anchored at cycle lows, the current bull tracks the 1995–2000 advance with a 0.95 path correlation and lands at September 1998. But an objective shape-match scan — sliding the recent tape across the entire 1995–2003 record — finds the single best fit for the last two years of price action ends **January 20, 2000** (correlation 0.948), six weeks before the top; a trusted-source cross-asset read (Big_Nuts, Section IV) independently places us in the distribution zone with a completed 5-wave advance at SPY 760.40. The fragility metrics agree with the later placement: top-10 concentration **36.3%** (vs ~25% in March 2000), negative equity risk premium (**-0.9%**), tech at **38.5%** of the index. What still argues against "the top is in": the leaders print real earnings (NVDA 15× forward on 85% revenue growth vs Cisco's ~130× in 2000), credit *spreads* are near 12-month lows, breadth is broadening, and the streams flag rotation — not exodus. Net: the melt-up is now the *upside scenario*, not the base case.

- **Don't chase 7,437** — top-zone risk is live now, not twelve months out.
- **Add zone: 7,170 → 6,920 SPX** (C-leg completion), confirmed by quiet credit (OAS <320bp, MOVE <110) · **invalidation:** weekly close below 6,344.
- **Upside trigger: breakout over 7,610 with breadth** (RSP/SPY rising) → 8,300–8,700 by mid-2027.
- **Hedge with collars/put-spreads, not outright puts** (8.5-pt vol premium) · companions: long IWM/RSP vs QQQ, TLT.

Bull-cycle overlay — indexed to 100 at cycle low, trading-day aligned

Current cycle from Oct 12 2022 low (■ blue) vs. dot-com cycle from Dec 1994 low (■ orange). Path correlation over the common window: **0.954**. Year ticks: **blue** = current-cycle calendar (dimmed = projected), **orange** = dot-com calendar.



II MARKET CONDITION DASHBOARD

S&P 500

7,437.63

-2.3% off Jun 2 ATH
7,610

YTD / 1-YR

+8.7%

+16.7% 1-yr · +5.9% vs
200dma

VIX

20.66

↑ from 14.5 six months
ago

REALIZED VOL (20D)

12.2

VRP +8.5 pts — hedges
bid

10Y / 30Y

4.67 / 5.20

Long end grinding up all
year

2S10S

+45bp

Un-inverted, flattening
from +72

HY OAS

287bp

Tight — no credit stress

FED FUNDS

3.63%

2Y at 4.22% — hike risk
priced

FIN. CONDITIONS

-0.55

NFCI loose; StL stress
-0.83

CONSUMER SENT.

49.8

UMich near record lows

POLICY UNCERTAINTY

283

Off the 672 February
panic

BREAKEVENS 10Y

2.27%

Anchored; real 10Y 2.41%

The condition in one sentence: liquidity is loose, credit is quiet, and the equity market made a new high five weeks ago — but the *price* of that calm is rising: the long bond at 5.20%, a re-hiking Fed being priced, volatility premium bid, and a consumer that hates everything about it (UMich 49.8 is depression-level sentiment against a +17% tape — the classic "most hated melt-up").

The tension defining the regime: **Bullish flow** loose financial conditions, tight credit, broadening breadth, small-cap leadership (best H1 in decades per the Finimize stream) — against **Bearish structure** negative ERP, record concentration, long-end supply pressure, equity-repo funding stress (Concoda stream: equity repo +150bp over SOFR, dealers charging up for levered longs — crowding measured in the plumbing).

Positioning read: the risk-reward on chasing strength is gone. A five-wave advance from the Oct-2022 low looks complete at 760.40 SPY and an A-B-C correction is underway — the C-leg zone (~7,170 SPX if C=A, ~6,920 at 1.618×A) is where the melt-up case gets its test; that's the add zone, not here. VIX 20.7 on 12.2 realized means outright puts are dear — finance protection (collars, put spreads) rather than paying the 8.5-point premium. The regime break to watch: **2Y above Fed funds (4.22 vs 3.63), the 30Y at 5.20%, and the 10Y breaking a cup-and-handle toward 4.94–5.05** — the bond market is pricing hike risk into an equity market priced for perfection.

III THE DOT-COM OVERLAY

The opening-page overlay indexes both cycles to 100 at their bear-market lows, aligned by trading day — the honest way to run a fractal (no date cherry-picking). The current cycle is **45.6 months** old at +108%; the same trading-day count into the dot-com bull landed on **Sep 15, 1998** — inside the LTCM crash trough, just before the final melt-up tripled the pace. The milestone map:

MILESTONE	DOT-COM CYCLE	CURRENT CYCLE
Cycle low	459.11 · Dec 8, 1994	3,577.03 · Oct 12, 2022
Gain to this point (same # trading days)	+133%	+108%
Mid-cycle shakeout	Jul–Aug 1998 · –19.3% (LTCM/Russia)	Jan–Mar 2026 · –9.1% (rate scare)
What followed the shakeout	+16% in 12m → Mar 2000 top	recovered to –2.3% off ATH · open
The bust, when it came	–49% peak-to-trough, 30 months	—

The KOL streams found this on their own: **Big_Nuts** is running the same 1997–2000 fractal ("potential for deeper drawdown", Jul 27), and **Feather Hands** called the melt-up phase off the same pattern in June. Peak-aligning their fractal — the 2026 correction against LTCM 1998:

The KOL fractal — 2026 correction aligned to the 1998 LTCM correction (peak = 100)

Jan 27 2026 peak (■) vs. Jul 17 1998 peak (■). 1998 drew down –19.3%, then rallied +16% in the 12 months after today's equivalent point (Jan 19 1999) — before the 2000 top.



What the analog does and doesn't say. It says mid-bull corrections in a mania resolve up, violently, and that the current drawdown was *half* the 1998 depth — this shakeout was mild by analog standards. It does **not** time the top: from the equivalent point the analog pays +16% over 12 months, +19% over 18 — and then gives back everything over the following 30 months (–49% from the 2000 peak). If the fractal holds, the melt-up window is roughly **through mid-2027**, and the exit signal matters more than the entry. In 2000 it was: breadth collapsing while the index rose, the 10Y at 6%+, and the Fed hiking into it. Watch list below maps those to 2026.

Where are we, objectively? The shape-match scan

To adjudicate placement without cherry-picking an anchor, the recent tape (z-scored log prices) was slid across every window of the 1995–2003 record. The two lookbacks disagree — and the disagreement *is* the finding:

LOOKBACK WINDOW	BEST MATCH ENDS	CORR.	RUNNERS-UP
Last 500 trading days (~2 yrs)	Jan 20, 2000	0.948	Oct 1997 (0.923) · Jul 1998 (0.912)
Last 250 trading days (~1 yr)	Aug 19, 1997	0.937	May 1998 (0.915) · Feb 2000 (0.849)
Cycle-low anchor (duration)	Sep 15, 1998	0.954*	*full-path correlation from lows

The two-year shape — correction, powerful recovery to marginal new highs, then churn — matches the six weeks before the 2000 top better than anything else in the record; it is the highest correlation found anywhere in the scan. The one-year shape still says 1997, and the duration anchor says 1998. Honest synthesis: **we are somewhere in the final third of the analog**, with the long-shape evidence — and the cross-asset tape below — arguing for the late end of the band.

IV THE CROSS-ASSET CHECK — BIG_NUTS' BOARD

Chart pack from the highest-trust KOL source (Jul 29), read against the analyzer's own series. This is the confirmation layer an index-only view misses — and most of it leans bearish-late-cycle:

INSTRUMENT	CHART READ	CROSS-CHECK VS ANALYZER DATA	STATE
HYG (weekly)	Rounding top under the 40/200-wk EMAs; arc projects ~77.5	HY OAS 287bp, ~30bp over 3m, near 12-mo lows — the slide is rates-driven, not credit-driven . Confirmation trigger: OAS > ~340bp	Amber
10Y yield	Stacked cup-and-handles; 2.618 extension 4.71 tagged, next cluster 4.94–5.05	10Y 4.67, 30Y 5.20 — every 2026 equity air-pocket has been a long-end event; 4.94+ is the multiple-killer zone	Red
MOVE (3D)	Low-70s, calm; red line at 133.7 — the two prior tags (Oct '24, Apr '25) boxed as regime events	The KOL timing gauge: MOVE >130 = Treasury market seizing → Fed forced to ease. A spike is crash-then-rescue, not just crash	Calm, tripwire set
USDJPY (daily)	163.4, post-1990 highs, riding the rising 40d EMA	Carry-trade at full stretch; the Aug-2024 unwind ignited from 162. Disorderly <i>yen strength</i> is the vol catalyst to fear	Amber
NQ futures	Wave-5 diamond top 30.4–31.2k broke down; measured target 27,466 — tagged this week	QQQ 3-month momentum lags SPY; leadership is already correcting. Bounce-or-break at the target shelf	Red
SPY (daily + 3D)	Five waves up from Oct-2022 complete at 760.40 on the 0.786 confluence (748.88); A-B-C underway — (A) ~718, (B) ~757, now in (C)	C=A projects ~715 SPY / ~7,170 SPX ; 1.618xA projects ~690 / ~6,920 — brackets the analyzer's 200dma zone and first shelf	Red

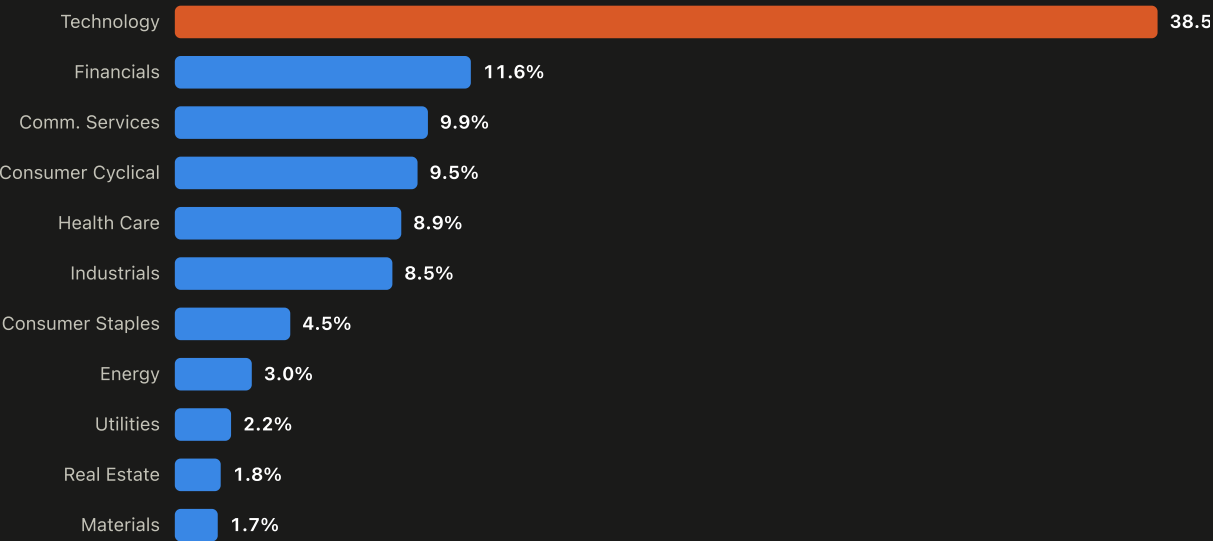
The Big_Nuts roadmap (SPX 3D projection): distribution in the **7,600–7,700** box — where price sits now — rolling over through shelves at **6,841** and **6,391** toward **~5,680 into late 2027**. That is –25% from the ATH: *half* a 2000-style bust, which is exactly what the composition section argues — profitable leaders make the downside Nifty-Fifty-shaped, not Nasdaq-2002-shaped. Their overlay places us farther ahead than the cycle-low anchor does, and the 500-day shape-match backs them. Where the roadmap is weakest: credit spreads and breadth are doing the *opposite* of what they did in the six weeks before March 2000 — the two divergences that must flip before "distribution" is confirmed over "consolidation."

V WHAT SPY ACTUALLY OWNS — COMPOSITION & VALUE

SPY is a \$781B fund charging 9.45bp for the most liquid equity exposure on earth, yielding 1.01%, trading at **26.7× trailing earnings** — a 3.75% earnings yield against a 4.67% 10-year. The equity risk premium is **−0.92%**: you are paid nothing over Treasuries to hold the index. The last time ERP was negative was the dot-com era (it bottomed near −3% in early 2000).

SPY sector weights

Technology at 38.5% now exceeds its ~34.8% share at the March 2000 peak.



Top 10 holdings — 36.3% of the fund

TICKER	NAME	WEIGHT	P/E	FWD P/E	REV GROWTH	NET MARGIN	MKT CAP
NVDA	NVIDIA Corporation	7.50%	29.1	15.2	85.2%	63.0%	\$4724B
AAPL	Apple Inc.	6.58%	41.0	34.5	16.6%	27.2%	\$4897B
MSFT	Microsoft Corporation	4.29%	21.7	19.5	18.3%	39.3%	\$3350B
AMZN	Amazon.com, Inc.	3.61%	28.2	23.7	16.6%	12.2%	\$2533B
GOOGL	Alphabet Inc.	3.24%	16.9	22.6	24.2%	54.8%	\$4081B
AVGO	Broadcom Inc.	2.77%	61.8	19.9	47.9%	38.8%	\$1845B
GOOG	Alphabet Inc.	2.58%	16.8	22.6	24.2%	54.8%	\$4081B
MU	Micron Technology, Inc.	2.01%	16.7	5.7	345.7%	55.9%	—
META	Meta Platforms, Inc.	1.91%	22.1	14.7	33.1%	32.8%	\$1373B
TSLA	Tesla, Inc.	1.83%	278.2	139.3	25.5%	3.7%	\$1220B

Fundamentals via live fetch, Jul 31 2026. Alphabet's trailing P/E is depressed by a one-time earnings surge; GOOGL+GOOG combined weight is 5.83%.

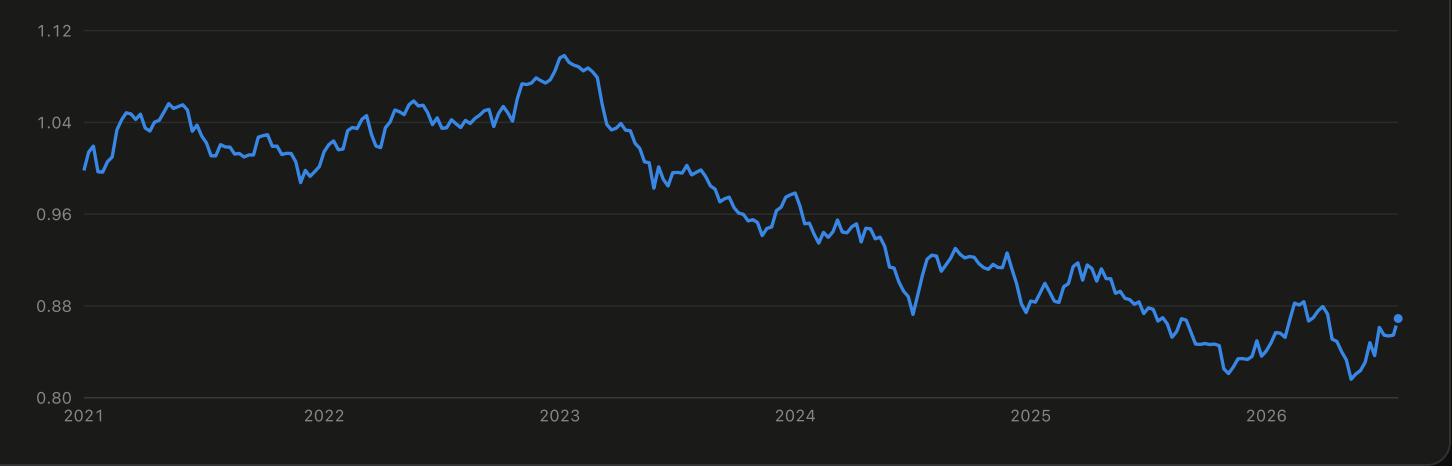
Today vs. March 2000 — the fragility scoreboard

METRIC	JUL 2026	MAR 2000	READ
Top-10 weight	36.3%	~25.5%	Worse than 2000
Tech sector weight	38.5%	~34.8%	Worse than 2000
Index trailing P/E	26.7×	~29.7×	Rich, below 2000
Top-10 weighted P/E	42.3×	~60×	Rich, below 2000
Equity risk premium	−0.9%	~−2.9%	Negative, less extreme
Leader economics	NVDA 63% margin, 15× fwd	CSCO ~130× fwd	Much better than 2000
10Y Treasury	4.67%	6.26%	Less restrictive

The compositional verdict: the index is *structurally* more concentrated than at any prior peak — a 7.5% NVIDIA position plus 2.0% Micron makes SPY a leveraged bet on the memory/compute cycle in a way it never was on routers in 2000. But the *quality* of that concentration is categorically different: the top 10 collectively run 25–60% net margins and trade at a weighted 42× trailing / ~22× forward, versus 2000's leaders which were priced at 60–130× on decelerating or absent earnings. Concentration risk today is an **earnings-cycle risk** (what if AI capex rolls over — the Forward Guidance stream's core thesis), not a **no-earnings bubble**. That's why the bust, when it comes, is more likely 1973-Nifty-Fifty-shaped (−40% then years of chop for the leaders while the equal-weight index survives) than 2000-Nasdaq-shaped (−80%).

Breadth — equal-weight vs cap-weight (RSP/SPY, indexed)

Three-year downtrend in breadth; the last 3 months turned UP (+3.2%) — equal-weight +7.9% vs SPY +4.5% — the rotation the streams flagged.



VI STREAM INTELLIGENCE — WHAT EVERY FEED IS SAYING

Consolidated index-level signal from all analyzer streams, last 60 days: **15 LONG · 5 SHORT · 19 WATCH · 1 AVOID**. Mention momentum on the SPX complex is **fading** (breakout score 11.6) after the early-June spike — attention has rotated to single names and small caps, itself a late-cycle tell.

STREAM / SOURCE	DATE	CALL	CONV.	THESIS
Wolf Pack (Telegram KOL)	Jul 27	SHORT SPX → 6,500	3.0	Mid-term-year seasonality: 10–20% correction into November; DXY holding 101 pressures equities.
Big_Nuts	Jul 27	WATCH	2.0	1997–2000 fractal — "potential for deeper drawdown." Same model, bearish tilt.
Forward Guidance (newsletter)	Jul 26	SHORT QQQ + LONG IWM	3.0	"AI unwind forcing a historic rotation" — most crowded trade cracking; value/small-cap revival.
Finimize	Jul 26	LONG IWM	3.0	Small caps +24% H1 — best start in decades; leadership rotating off Mag-7.
Concorda (Substack, plumbing)	Jul 26	WATCH SPX	2.0	Equity repo +150bp over SOFR — dealers charging up for stock leverage; massive levered-long demand.
Ari's Relays (aggregator — forwards other channels)	Jun 5 → Jul 27	JUN RELAY PLAYED OUT ✓	2.5	The Jun 5 "major profit-taking in weeks" relay verified : NQ −12% into the diamond breakdown, BTC −20% to the 62.5K zone. Current relayed flow (Jul 27) is dollar-long FX (USDJPY/USDCHF long, EUR short), gold and oil on watch — no fresh index short circulating . Read as a consensus-flow gauge, not independent conviction.
Feather Hands	Jun 5 → Jul 27	DEFENSIVE TURN LONG TLT	3.0	The Jun 5 melt-up long is stale — the book has rotated defensive: BTC and ETH stopped out, MSTR short (3.0), TLT long (2.5) on the "Warsh lets banks buy the front end → non-QE monetization → cuts" thesis, silver long ~\$50, GLD breakout contingent on QE. Their live SPX line is the Big_Nuts fractal watch above.
Gov-insider (Senate disclosures)	Jun 1 (filed)	NET BUYING STALE	3.0	Perdue: SPY purchases in \$500K–\$5M brackets alongside partial sales; Carper spouse adding. STOCK Act filings lag ~45 days — these trades executed Apr–May ; positioning context, not current signal. No fresher batch in the stream.
Social (WSB / StockTwits)	Jul 21	WATCH SPY·QQQ·ES	1.0	Mention-rank spikes on index tickers — retail attention elevated but not manic.

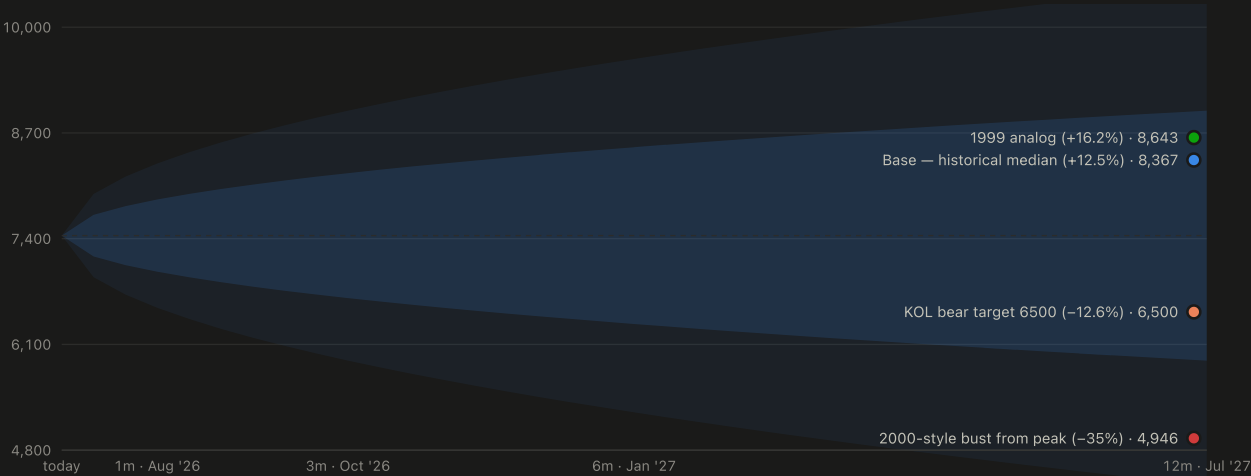
Freshness audit (Jul 31): the Jun 5 profit-taking short that circulated via Ari's Relays **played out** (NQ −12%, BTC −20%) — credit the relayed consensus, and note the same flow is *not* re-shortening the index now. Feather Hands' Jun 5 melt-up long is dead — their live book (crypto stopped out, MSTR short, TLT long) is the most defensive this cycle. Gov-insider is structurally ~60 days lagged; positioning context only.

Cross-stream synthesis: nobody credible is calling an imminent bust — the live bears (Wolf Pack) call a *tradeable correction* to ~6,500, the −12% zone the probability table prices at ~1-in-5 over six months. But the freshness audit shifts the tone: the June bull leg's authors have rotated defensive, and the live KOL tape now leans risk-off — consistent with the correction-first weighting in Section VII. The strongest-conviction consensus across streams remains the **rotation**: out of crowded AI mega-cap into small caps, value, and now *duration* (Feather Hands' TLT long joins the IWM leg) — visible in RSP/SPY turning up and the Forward Guidance thesis. For SPY holders rotation is a *stabilizer* (the other 490 catch the baton), unless it becomes an AI capex unwind, which hits 40%+ of the fund. One new policy vector worth tracking from the Feather Hands book: if Warsh does free banks to absorb front-end Treasury supply, that's the MOVE-rescue / liquidity path arriving *without* a crash first — a quiet tailwind the bear cases aren't pricing.

VII PROBABILITIES & EXPECTED MOVES

VIX-implied expected-move cone — SPX from 7,438

Shaded: ±1σ (inner) and ±2σ (outer) implied by VIX 20.66. Markers: scenario targets. 1σ 12-month range ≈ 5,901–8,974.



The probability table

Two independent estimates: option-implied (VIX 20.66, symmetric 1σ) and historical forward returns since 1994, *conditioned on today's realized-vol regime* (n≈4,000 windows).

HORIZON	IMPLIED ±1Σ	SPX 1Σ RANGE	HIST. MEDIAN	P(UP)	P(>+10%)	P(<-5%)	P(<-10%)	P(<-20%)
1m Aug 28 '26	±5.96%	6,994–7,881	+1.1%	64.2%	0.1%	6.6%	1.4%	0.2%
3m Oct 28 '26	±10.33%	6,669–8,206	+3.1%	69.5%	6.3%	10.9%	3.9%	0.2%
6m Jan 27 '27	±14.61%	6,351–8,524	+5.9%	75.9%	26.4%	13.0%	6.3%	1.9%
12m Jul 29 '27	±20.66%	5,901–8,974	+12.5%	83.1%	58.4%	12.1%	9.1%	4.2%

Scenario map — 12 months (through Jul 2027)

SCENARIO	PROB.	SPX TARGET	PATH & TRIGGER
Tradeable correction first (the C-leg)	30%	6,900–7,170 (Aug–Nov '26), then recover	The A-B-C completes at C=A (~7,170) or 1.618×A (~6,920), holds the 200dma shelf, and the melt-up case gets one more leg. The Wolf Pack 6,500 flush into November is the deep version.
Melt-up resumes (1999 analog)	28%	8,300–8,700 by mid-'27	Fed stays paused, AI earnings deliver, rotation broadens the tape past 7,610 with RSP/SPY rising. Analog pays +16%; conditional median +12.5%. Now the upside scenario, not the default.
Choppy range	22%	7,000–7,700 through H1 '27	Long-end pins the multiple; distribution-vs-consolidation stays unresolved under a flat index. The "1994-inside-a-bull" outcome.
Bust begins (Big_Nuts roadmap)	17%	<6,400 in '27 → ~5,680 trough early '28	Wave-5 top at 760.40 SPY confirmed: 10Y through 4.94–5.05, OAS >340bp, breadth rolls, AI capex guides down. Shelves 6,841 → 6,391 → 5,680 (–25% from ATH). Historical P(<–20%)≈4%, ~4× for the 500-day 2000-match + negative ERP + completed wave count.
Right-tail mania	3%	>9,000 (H2 '26 blowoff)	1999-Q4-style blowoff: +20%+ in months. VIX-implied P ≈ 8% unconditionally; hasn't happened from a negative-ERP start.

Reading the 1σ ranges: they are **endpoint** distributions — 5,901–8,974 is the ~68% band for where SPX *trades at the 12-month mark* (Jul '27), not the expected high-low path over the year; the tape will travel outside narrower interim bands along the way, and the symmetric approximation understates the left tail. Probabilities are a judgment layer over the implied and conditional-historical bases, tilted by the Big_Nuts cross-asset board, the 500-day Jan-2000 shape-match, and the completed 5-wave count. Revised Jul 31. Not investment advice.

VIII SUMMARY, LEVELS & WATCH LIST

The dossier in one paragraph: SPX 7,437 (−2.3% off the June ATH), 45.6 months and +108% into a bull that tracks the 1995–2000 advance at 0.95 correlation. The placement evidence brackets **late-1998 to early-2000** — and the 500-day shape-match, the completed 5-wave count at SPY 760.40, and the Big_Nuts cross-asset board all argue the late end. Composition is 2000-grade fragile (top-10 36.3%, tech 38.5%, ERP −0.9%) but earnings-real, so the bust case is −25% Nifty-Fifty-shaped, not −49%. Twelve-month odds: **correction-first 30% · melt-up 28% · chop 22% · bust-onset 17% · mania 3%**. Don't chase — the add zone is the C-leg at 7,170/6,920; finance protection with spreads; the flip triggers are below.

The chips-on setup (highest probability per this dossier's own math): stalk the C-leg completion at **7,170 → 6,920 SPX** (SPY ~715 → 690) between now and ~November; buy the hold of that shelf *with credit quiet* (OAS <320bp, MOVE <110) as confirmation; invalidation = weekly close below **6,344** (the bull/bear line); targets 7,610, then **8,300–8,700 by mid-2027**. Why it's the highest-probability expression: 58% of the scenario weight (correction-first 30% + melt-up 28%) resolves upward from a lower entry, historical P(up, 12m) in this vol regime is 83%, and entering at the shelf converts the bust scenario into a small defined loss instead of a −25% ride. Highest-consensus companion: **long IWM/RSP vs QQQ** rotation (every fresh stream leans that way); Feather Hands' **TLT long** doubles as the hedge that pays in both the hike-scare and the rescue. Not investment advice.

Near-term reference levels

- **1-week 1σ (Aug 6):** ±2.9% → SPX 7,221–7,654 (SPY \$720–763)
- **1-month 1σ (Aug 28):** ±6.0% → SPX 6,994–7,881 (SPY \$697–786) · historical P(up) 64%
- **Support:** 7,316 (last week's low) → 6,979 (Jan peak, first shelf) → 6,650 (200dma zone) → 6,500 (KOL target / Mar low retest) → 6,344 (Mar 30 trough — bull/bear line)
- **Resistance:** 7,610 (Jun 2 ATH) → measured-move ~7,880 on a breakout (= 1-month +1σ)

Turns the melt-up into the top (2000 triggers, 2026 form)

- Fed **re-hikes** (2Y already at 4.22 vs 3.63 funds; a July/Sep hike = 2000's tightening-into-strength)
- **10Y through 4.94–5.05** (the cup-and-handle target) or 30Y > 5.5% — the multiple's ceiling; every 2026 air-pocket has been a long-end event
- **HY OAS > ~340bp** — converts the HYG rounding top from a rates story into a credit story
- **Breadth divergence at a new high** — RSP/SPY rolling over while SPX prints ATH (the Mar-2000 signature; today it's doing the opposite)
- **AI capex guide-downs** — MU is now 2% of SPY; hyperscaler capex is the earnings transmission line for 40% of the fund
- **SPY loses the C=A shelf (~715)** and NQ fails to reclaim ~29,500 (the diamond apex) — the wave count's confirmation
- Disorderly **yen strength off the 164 zone** (carry unwind) or equity-repo spread widening past +150bp over SOFR — the two forced-deleveraging channels

Confirms the 1999 leg (adds to melt-up odds)

- SPX closes above **7,610** with RSP/SPY still rising — broad-participation breakout
- Wolf Pack's **6,800 line**: their own model flips bullish above it "sustainably" — already reclaimed; a Q3 hold converts a bear
- VIX back under 16 while realized stays low — hedge premium unwinds into fuel
- Fed cuts resume (UMich 49.8 gives them the consumer cover)
- IWM/value leg keeps absorbing rotation without index damage — 1998-Q4 signature
- **MOVE spikes through 130** then reverses — the KOL gauge: Treasury seizure forces Fed liquidity; historically the rescue, not the top (crash-then-rip)
- The C-leg completes at 7,170/6,920 SPX on *quiet* credit (OAS still <320) — correction proven technical, add zone triggers

Methodology. FRED + Yahoo ^GSPC 1994–2026; SPY composition fetched live Jul 31. Overlays indexed to 100 at cycle lows, trading-day aligned; conditional distributions filtered to today's vol regime; implied moves $VIX \times \sqrt{(t/252)}$; shape-match on z-scored

250/500-day windows vs 1995–2003; cross-asset from the Big_Nuts pack (Jul 29). Probabilities involve judgment — decision-support, not investment advice.